A SPACE-FANTASY ROLEPLAYING GAME

LANTERN REACH

Explorer's Expansion

New characters, rites and ranks 1-20



OPEN HORIZONS / ALPHA 0.3.1 / PLAYTEST EDITION

An original space-fantasy adventure RPG.
Pantheons. Strange worlds. A crew of your own.

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Using this book

Open Horizons is an original manuscript expansion for Lantern Reach. Use the original Player's and Guide's books for the core 2d6 rules. This volume adds material; it does not replace the core resolution engine.

The Explorer's Expansion contains player options, rites, equipment and ranks 11-20. The Frontier Guide contains creature profiles, twelve destinations, nine keyed adventures and campaign procedures. The two books share a short expedition charter so either volume explains compatibility.

Choose the expansion scope together before introducing new options. The offline companion supports the original core options and ranks 1-10; expansion characters use paper sheets or notes. The companion does not calculate these new identities or high-rank abilities.

Species, present body, profession, religious tradition and citizenship are independent choices. Pantheons remain central without making every adventure a religious struggle. The frontier includes rescue, discovery, politics, ecology, trade and ordinary working life.

This material has editorial and production checks, not completed live tabletop playtests. The rank extension, new powers and encounter combinations require table testing. No claim of proven balance or commercial breadth is made.

Readiness and ownership

Players own their characters' beliefs and choices. Agree on tone before play and pause when needed. No rule forces religious conviction, personal disclosure or one predetermined solution to a scene. A Guide gives concrete opportunities and consequences, then lets the crew choose its route.

Open Horizons / Expedition charter

Open Horizons expands Lantern Reach into a longer space-fantasy campaign game. It adds character options, a larger power library, equipment, creatures, a frontier atlas and two adventure arcs. Use the original Player's and Guide's books for core resolution. Everything here is original tabletop material, independent of proposed Manifest Destiny / ROZ canon.

This is a manuscript expansion, not proof of competitive balance. Its options work on paper with the existing 2d6 rules. The offline companion currently implements the original rank 1-10 options; it does not calculate these new Lineages, Vocations, Disciplines, rites or rank 11-20 features. Use a paper sheet or notes for expansion characters. Never import an unsupported identity and assume the app retained it.

Choose the campaign's scope

At campaign start the table chooses Core or Open Horizons. In Open Horizons, all players may choose the new character options. A player may keep a core character without penalty. Existing campaigns can adopt the expansion between adventures; each player may exchange one Vocation, Discipline, Embodiment or starting rite package once, preserving rank, wounds, gear and earned relationships. This is a transition allowance, not repeatable tactical rebuilding.

The three Pantheons remain Order, Ancients and Divinity. Additional religious orders are schools, institutions or communities within or across those traditions, not extra mechanical Pantheons. Secular commitments remain possible interpretations of personal Creeds. No society is assigned a compulsory body, faith or class.

What is in the expansion

Library	New material	Use
Peoples and bodies	Four Lineages, three Embodiments, eight Provenances	Broader identity without species/class restrictions
Vocations and Disciplines	Six Vocations; three Disciplines with foundations and electives	Twelve total Vocations and eight total Disciplines across core and expansion
Rite codex	Forty-five rites across the three Pantheons	Combat powers, exploration, rituals and high-rank choices
Ranks 11-20	Ten ranks, legendary undertakings, institutions and long projects	Larger stakes without escalating attributes or extra attacks
Equipment and vessels	Weapons, tools, relics, vehicles and three more ship frames	New approaches and logistical decisions
Frontier bestiary	Thirty-six individual adversary/creature profiles	Opposition, wildlife, allies and component bosses
Frontier atlas	Twelve destinations, connected routes and faction institutions	A campaign beyond the starter sector
Broken Beacon / Choir Below	Six keyed adventures in two arcs	Low/middle-rank rescue politics and high-rank frontier discovery
Independent expeditions	Three more keyed adventures	Relic-vault crawl, wilderness hunt and legendary siege evacuation
Zone maps	Nine printable vector maps	Numbered areas and alternate routes for all new adventures
Campaign procedures	Research, negotiation, faction projects, settlements and encounter assembly	Repeatable play between and within adventures

Rules that still apply

Revision 0.3.1 also adds the core **Push** choice: 1 activation Strain for +1 damage to one target or +1 task progress on success, declared before a personal strike, damaging hostile rite or task action. Sum activation Strain before Fracture; Push changes effect rather than dice. Brief observance now takes ten peaceful minutes once/expedition, restoring personal Conviction to 3 without a downtime project. The core rules govern timing and exclusions. Six field wonders enrich expedition rewards without adding another currency.

Roll 2d6 + one attribute + at most one relevant expertise + net situation capped at -1/0/+1. Attributes remain capped at +3. One move and one action per activation, one supplied reaction per round. No universal opportunity attacks. Use core damage order and Downed rules. Conviction remains 3, Strain fractures at 4, wounds retire at 3. Ordinary temporary Guard is at most 1 and does not stack. Supply remains 8 and Stores 6 unless a particular vessel explicitly provides a separate cargo space; cargo never increases those resource caps.

Duration: "next turn" means the end of the affected character's next turn unless the power says otherwise. "Scene" means a meaningful change of objective or pressure, not another room. Once/scene and once/session limits attach to the named

feature. Two copies of a named effect never stack; only the stronger applies. Features that add a target never add another action. A character cannot use two reactions on the same trigger.

Resources: pay activation costs before rolling. Sum one activation's Strain costs per payer as one packet, resolve any Fracture, then continue if able. Result Strain occurs afterward as a separate packet. No refund unless stated. A protected or successful action never automatically refunds a rite's Conviction. New abilities cannot create Supply, Stores, permanent followers or unlimited healing from nothing.

Choices: all new Lineages, bodies, Vocations, Disciplines and Pantheons combine freely. Starting equipment accommodates the chosen body. A feature permitting an unusual task does not grant a generic numerical bonus. An ability affecting a willing target requires real consent, not a successful social roll. Rites and psionics cannot settle another character's religious beliefs.

A first expansion session

For rank 2-4, begin with The Broken Beacon. Use core ready explorers or new characters made with the same attribute array, starting Guard and milestone budget. Choose one of the new Provenances if desired. Start the crew with a core Courier, 4 Supply, 4 Stores and 2 Accord. Read only the player options actually selected and the first adventure. The entire library is not homework.

For rank 6-10, begin with The Choir Below. Give each explorer normal group-rank advancement, two ordinary equipment purchases totaling at most 3 Supply and one studied relic chosen with the Guide. That allowance happens once at campaign creation. Do not grant a private ship or independent Supply pool per character.

Conversion record

Write the enabled expansion chapters on the first page of the campaign log. List each chosen option and its rules source. When a rule is unclear, record the table ruling and review it after the session. Do not silently replace an option mid-scene or remove a player's established ability because a later manuscript changed. An expansion character is ready when another player can explain their action, costs, limits and recovery without relying on the author.

01 / Peoples, bodies and beginnings

These options add to core Lineages and Embodiments. Choose exactly one of each. Lineage describes inherited nature, not allegiance or temperament. Embodiment describes a present body, not a compulsory profession. All starting suits, communicators and kits accommodate the body without an additional cost. Bodies can change during a campaign; replacing an Embodiment requires willing treatment, suitable facilities and one downtime interval, exchanges rather than stacks its features, and never removes wounds automatically.

Four additional Lineages

Ilyri

Ilyri evolved with membranous mantle organs that sense air movement. Communities include high-atmosphere survey cooperatives, enclosed urban districts and oceanic settlers who rarely use their mantles. Clothing and environmental adaptations are individual choices.

Adaptation - Pressure Reading: in ordinary atmosphere, detect a recently opened nearby physical passage after one minute in your zone; learn the direction of its airflow and whether the pressure beyond is higher or lower. No roll unless an active hazard interrupts examination.

Limit: it cannot map the next room, identify people, detect a sealed door's past use or function in vacuum. It grants no defense bonus. Gear can create misleading currents; examination reveals the airflow source, not its intent.

Play questions: What journey did your family expect you to make? Which enclosed place feels like home? An Ilyri metallurgist, cleric or Continuant is as ordinary a possibility as an aerial scout.

Tessari

Tessari have distributed chromatophores and excellent control over patterned light reflected from their skin. Their cities use public color-signs alongside sound and writing, but no culture shares one universal color language. Mixed communities invent local dialects.

Adaptation - Quiet Signal: communicate a brief prepared message to a willing observer in your own or an adjacent visible zone without sound. At the start of an expedition agree on up to six signals with the crew. Sending one on your turn needs no action; explaining a complex plan does.

Limit: light and line of sight are necessary. It does not grant camouflage, translation, mental contact or an edge on deception. An observer who knows the code can read it. Changing the code needs ten safe minutes together.

Play questions: Who taught you a private signal? What mark do you display openly? A mechanical Tessari may use installed light panels without gaining extra biological features.

Asteri

Asteri maintain symbiotic mineral filaments that record slow changes in temperature and vibration. A body can support that association biologically or through an adapted housing. Families and institutions disagree over which records should remain private.

Adaptation - Patient Witness: after resting against a fixed surface for ten minutes, learn whether it experienced a significant heat surge or heavy impact during the previous watch. The Guide states the kind of physical trace or confirms none.

Limit: no exact scene replay, names, spoken words or supernatural truth. Moving objects break continuity; insulation can prevent recording. This is observation, not proof of blame. You still need a separate research project to interpret complex machinery.

Play questions: Which historical account do you doubt? Who entrusted you with a record? The association does not make you resistant to weapons, poison or vacuum.

Koruun

Koruun are small-bodied people with dexterous paired climbing limbs. Their habitats range from crowded shipyards to broad communal gardens. Their history includes both migration and long settlement; small stature does not imply servitude or comic behavior.

Adaptation - Sure Hold: climb an ordinary rough surface within your zone without a routine check, leaving your main manipulators free for a carried tool. A proper route still takes movement or a task action when time matters.

Limit: smooth walls, unstable surfaces, armed pursuit and vacuum remain hazards. You cannot cling to a ship under thrust without suitable anchors. No extra item use, action or weapon attack comes from additional limbs. Narrow maintenance openings admit you only when the fiction establishes that they fit.

Play questions: Which enormous place did you help build? What possession is worth carrying across a world? Describe adapted controls rather than imposing a penalty to all ordinary equipment.

Three additional Embodiments

Choose these instead of a core Embodiment. Their appearance is yours to describe. None changes Lineage, Pantheon or citizenship.

Embodiment	Feature	Cost and boundary
Symbiotic	Once/scene, action: while touching a conscious willing creature in your zone, exchange an ordinary toxin or irritant sample with your symbiont. Identify one practical treatment or isolation measure if it is a known local substance; otherwise learn a safe way to preserve the sample	Needs a medical kit and a sample. Identification does not cure, grant immunity or read memories. Unknown organisms require research
Modular	Once/scene, spend ten safe minutes exchanging an integrated ordinary utility fitting: light, recording lens, manipulator or connector. The fitting becomes hands-free until changed	Choose one installed fitting. It is a tool, not a weapon, armor, extra limb action or free purchased module. Replacements require an available compatible part; starting kit includes two choices
Resonant	Once/scene, action +1 Strain: tune your voice or emitter to a known ordinary carrier signal in your zone. Send a brief message to an active compatible receiver in an adjacent zone despite ordinary noise	Shielding, encryption and vacuum without radio block the relevant method. It does not seize networks or compel listeners. Resolve Fracture before transmission

The body is never a second Discipline tree. A Symbiotic character may study Mechanist practice; a Modular person may be a Biotic physician; a Resonant body need not be psionic. Treat an accessibility aid as part of the person's ordinary life rather than a recurring inventory tax.

Eight additional Provenances

Choose one at creation in place of a core Provenance. Gain its expertise and one named reachable contact, identified together with the Guide. A contact's service is once/adventure, requires actual communication and consent, and never supplies an extra combatant automatically. Trust can change the relationship through play.

Provenance	Expertise	Contact service
Habitat-Grown	Machinery	Habitat steward: identify a public maintenance route and its current closure; no private security override
Convoy-Kin	Spacecraft	Convoy factor: arrange a berth or ordinary cargo introduction at a known port; passage still has a price
Treaty-Ward	Records	Interpreter: explain one local formal obligation and a recognized way to contest it; no authority to cancel it
Storm-Schooled	Routes	Weather observer: supply one watch's reliable forecast at a monitored destination; no data from an unvisited world
Archive-Raised	Records	Archivist: produce one accessible nonprivate historical source or tell you who restricts it; the source may be mistaken
Clinic-Fostered	Care	Practitioner: provide safe treatment space for one day; you still pay wound care or materials costs
Festival-Taught	Improvisation	Event worker: arrange an ordinary public performance or service venue; no guaranteed audience, revenue or agreement
Border-Resident	Watchfulness	Mediator: introduce one person willing to explain a local grievance; no automatic ceasefire or faction Trust

Identity at the table

Write one institution you belong to, one relationship across a religious or cultural boundary, and one thing you refuse to let others decide for you. These are prompts, not alignment restrictions. An institution grants access only when its ordinary rules and your actual relationship permit it. Changing a body or rejecting a belief does not erase a contact's memory, create an enemy by rule or demand a moral penalty.

To introduce a new people, give the first three encountered members different jobs and opinions. A Koruun harbor representative, Tessari rescue pilot and human mechanical theologian can share a civic organization while disagreeing sharply about its next contract. Explain a specific institution's policy rather than attributing that policy to an entire species.

02 / Vocations and Disciplines

Choose a Vocation independently of Pantheon, body and society. Each new Vocation receives its starting talent at rank 1, its second talent at rank 3 and third at rank 5. Choose one technique at rank 1 and gain the other at rank 4. All other core advancement remains unchanged. A technique uses an action unless explicitly stated otherwise. No package grants an extra attack, activation or unrestricted expertise bonus.

Six additional Vocations

Chirurgeon

You preserve people under conditions where ordinary care breaks down. Your practice can be biological, mechanical, spiritual or mixed. You are not required for a crew to stabilize a fallen ally or use ordinary Recovery.

Starting talent - Triage Eye: once/scene, free observation of a visible willing or unconscious creature: learn whether it is Downed, stabilized or in immediate environmental danger, and one reachable safe treatment position. Does not identify concealed disease or a creature's private history.

Rank 3 - Steady Hands: once/scene, when you stabilize an ally in your zone, that ally also clears 1 Strain. The stabilization wound still applies and they remain Downed.

Rank 5 - Evacuation Window: once/scene after you stabilize someone, you and that person may move together to one adjacent safe zone. This is part of the stabilization action, not an additional action or attack; the route must fit both.

Technique A - Field Dressing: once/scene, action with a medical/repair kit: a conscious willing target in your zone regains 2 Guard. Cannot target yourself, revive, treat wounds or be repeated through a renamed scene.

Technique B - Quarantine Craft: once/scene, spend ten minutes with tools and shelter material: establish one zone as ordinary contamination control until disturbed or scene end. It prevents transfer by casual touch between separated groups, not airborne toxins, pressure loss or deliberate breaches. State which route remains usable.

Kit: compatible treatment kit, close weapon, light armor, rescue sling. **Decision:** treat a conscious ally now, stabilize someone, or spend your action moving them to safety.

Corsair

You work boarding corridors, disputed cargo routes and precarious ceasefires. This profession can describe a lawful customs officer, a free captain or an outlaw. It does not grant permission to take another player's possessions.

Starting talent - Breach Read: once/scene after inspecting a visible entry point, learn whether opening it immediately causes decompression, an alarm or neither according to observable fixtures. Unknown concealed systems remain unknown.

Rank 3 - Boarding Footwork: once/scene after a successful close strike, move yourself to an adjacent safe zone. Deal normal damage; this movement cannot carry someone or trigger another strike.

Rank 5 - Controlled Retreat: once/scene when using Boarding Footwork, one conscious willing ally in your original zone may accompany you. Both arrive in the same destination; neither gains an action.

Technique A - Cut the Line: make a normal close strike against a human-scale enemy with a visibly carried tether, cable or ordinary held tool. On success replace all damage with severing the exposed tether or dropping that tool. Cannot destroy integrated anatomy or a ship's hull. Normal partial/miss costs apply.

Technique B - Terms Across the Hatch: once/scene, action while a speaking opponent can hear you: offer a concrete exchange for one round's truce. Learn whether it would accept and what safeguard it requires. Acceptance is voluntary; the response is truthful about present intent, not a binding future oath.

Kit: boarding blade, light armor, cutting torch, tether. **Decision:** control an entry, interrupt logistics or exploit a brief opening to withdraw.

Surveyor

You make strange environments legible. An expedition needs your judgment, not a mandatory scanning minigame. Your observations reveal actionable facts rather than an automatic answer to every mystery.

Starting talent - First Reading: once/scene after a minute observing a landscape or structure, identify one visible environmental hazard and the sign preceding its next occurrence. The Guide answers from the actual site; no hazard means “none visible.”

Rank 3 - Field Markers: once/scene, action: mark a safe route you personally crossed between two adjacent zones. Until disturbed or scene end, willing travelers can follow it without a routine navigation check. Active enemies, moving terrain and changing hazards still require resolution.

Rank 5 - Shared Map: when setting Field Markers, include a second connected route you actually crossed. Markers grant no speed, armor or ship navigation benefit.

Technique A - Sample Discipline: once/scene, ten minutes with survey tools: preserve one local sample for later analysis without ordinary degradation for an expedition. It does not identify, duplicate or make the sample harmless.

Technique B - Find the Interface: once/scene, action examining a visible structure: learn one reachable physical point through which it takes power, matter or signals, or that none is observable. This reveals an approach, not the result of altering it.

Kit: sample case, survey tools, ranged weapon, light armor. **Decision:** document a route, expose a hazard or preserve the evidence before it changes.

Marshal

You organize movement and responsibility under pressure. Your authority is earned or negotiated; choosing this Vocation does not give legal jurisdiction over the crew.

Starting talent - Clear Assignment: once/scene, action: name one visible physical objective and a conscious willing ally in your zone. Their next roll toward that objective before your next turn gains an edge. This replaces ordinary Help, cannot stack with it and does not make an attack an objective task.

Rank 3 - Contingency: once/scene, when the ally's supported task fails, they may move to one adjacent safe zone after resolving the failure and its consequences. They do not reroll or avoid damage already suffered.

Rank 5 - Orderly Withdrawal: once/scene, react after a visible ally in your zone defends successfully: let that ally move to an adjacent safe zone. This consumes your reaction, not theirs, and adds no attack or action.

Technique A - Secure the Position: once/scene, action: designate ordinary cover you occupy. Until your next turn a second willing ally in your zone may share that cover if the fiction allows two occupants. Attacking or moving ends cover for the individual doing so.

Technique B - Account for Everyone: once/scene after a minute comparing agreed crew signals or headcounts, learn which crew member failed to check in and their last established location. No tracking beyond known communications, no psychic link and no automatic reveal of an abductor.

Kit: communicator, signal kit, ranged weapon, light armor. **Decision:** support the task, secure shelter or spend your reaction on a retreat.

Cipher

You work with access, hidden records and misleading systems. A sentient mechanical person is a person rather than an unattended computer. Your techniques never seize a player's body or read a mind as if it were a terminal.

Starting talent - Audit Trail: once/scene after ten minutes examining a reachable record system, discover whether a specific known entry was altered during the last watch, and the visible credential used if a log survives. Destroyed logs yield the fact that the trail ends.

Rank 3 - Quiet Preparation: once/scene after successfully completing a noncombat device task, suppress its ordinary completion notification until the end of your next turn. Does not silence an alarm from failure, independent observers or another system.

Rank 5 - Prepared Exit: once/scene, after using Quiet Preparation, unlock one ordinary connected service latch in your zone if your current credential actually permits it. No bypass of encryption, pressure seals or unrelated networks.

Technique A - Spoof Credential: roll Insight with appropriate expertise at a reachable non-sentient terminal to imitate one previously examined ordinary access token. Use a task clock if protected. Success provides one use of that token's actual permissions; partial/miss consequences are announced before rolling. It cannot invent authorization or transfer a person's identity.

Technique B - Cold Copy: once/scene, action at an accessible recording device: preserve a readable copy of one file you can already access and mark the copy with its source/time. Copying does not prove truth, decrypt it or delete the original.

Kit: portable terminal, recording kit, close weapon, light armor. **Decision:** take a noisy shortcut, preserve a trail or spend time learning what a credential can really do.

Cantor

You shape attention through song, speech, embodied performance or a compatible signal. Your audiences can be religious, civic or intimate. Performance is not compulsory mind control and audiences can refuse to listen.

Starting talent - Common Measure: once/scene, action with a conscious willing ally in your zone: the ally clears 1 Strain if you both can exchange a prepared rhythm or signal. You gain 1 Strain. Resolve your Fracture after their relief; cannot target yourself.

Rank 3 - Carry the Chorus: when using Common Measure, you may target an ally in an adjacent visible zone if a working audible/radio path exists. Shielding, silence and disconnected channels matter.

Rank 5 - Refrain: once/scene after you receive Strain through Common Measure, one conscious willing ally in your zone gains 1 temporary Guard until scene end. Normal nonstacking limit; no revival.

Technique A - Hold Attention: once/scene, action while a willing audience can perceive your performance: learn one publicly voiced concern shared by at least two listeners, or learn that no such concern emerges. The Guide may offer a way to seek a private interview. No forced confession or guaranteed agreement.

Technique B - Timing Cue: once/scene, action +1 Strain: signal a conscious willing ally in your own or an adjacent visible zone. It may spend its reaction to end one ordinary physical pin immediately, or move one adjacent safe zone if not pinned. No attack, extra action, locked-restraint bypass or teleportation. Resolve your Fracture before the signal; the ally needs its reaction available.

Kit: performance instrument/emitter, communicator, close weapon, light armor. **Decision:** transfer pressure, create coordination or invite people to speak.

Three additional Disciplines

Choose one Discipline at rank 2. New Disciplines use the same ranks as the core: foundation plus one elective at rank 2, 6 and 9. A feature only does what it says; descriptive expertise does not add a new attribute bonus. At legendary ranks use the mastery choices in the long-campaign chapter rather than gaining every elective.

Navigator

Novice foundation, rank 2 - Route Ledger: once/scene, after a successful navigation or ship Maneuver roll, record one visible route condition. Before scene end, a willing ally following that exact route may ignore one ordinary navigation uncertainty caused solely by that condition. Active enemies and changed hazards still apply.

Adept foundation, rank 6 - Safe Approach: once/scene, action at a ship navigation station while Engagement 0: identify one reachable approach that avoids an announced ordinary debris or traffic hazard. Following it costs one additional watch. If no route exists, learn that without spending the watch; no free Stores or escape during pursuit.

Master foundation, rank 9 - Recall the Crossing: once/session, ten minutes with your own recorded charts: locate the last safe stopping point along a route the crew actually traveled this expedition. You can navigate back by paying ordinary legs, time and Stores; changing geography and hostile occupation are revealed, not canceled.

Tier	Choose one elective	Effect
Novice	**Tether Geometry**	Once/scene, action with anchors: a willing ally can cross one adjacent zone connection through ordinary zero gravity without a routine movement roll; active fire still requires defense
Novice	**Watch Rotation**	Once/expedition, spend one safe watch with the crew assigning duties: reveal which next leg lacks sufficient ordinary personnel or supplies; no free replacement crew
Novice	**Local Sky**	Once/scene, minute observing a known star/landmark: establish true local direction despite ordinary compass interference; unfamiliar or shielded environments require another method
Adept	**Approach Screen**	Once/ship scene, successful Maneuver may give the next allied station task an edge instead of changing Engagement
Adept	**Drift Anchor**	Once/scene, reaction while properly tethered: keep one willing creature in your zone from drifting to an adjacent zone. You gain 1 Strain; normal damage remains
Adept	**Port Memory**	Once/adventure, produce one public docking custom from a previously visited port; the Guide gives a usable contact or tells you how the custom changed
Master	**Cut the Chase**	Once/session, successful Maneuver at Engagement 1 may move to 0 even when one named ordinary obstacle would prevent that change; costs 1 Stores, requires a physically open route and does not complete the later escape Maneuver
Master	**Return Signal**	Once/session, action with a functioning transmitter: guide a willing lost nearby party onto a marked traversable route in the same site. Needs communication; no teleportation, interstellar rescue or removal of active hazards

Tier	Choose one elective	Effect
Master	**Chart the Impossible**	Once/session, ten-minute examination: learn one specific instrument or physical condition required to test an apparently impossible route. It provides a research lead rather than automatic passage

Warden

Novice foundation, rank 2 - Field Shelter: once/scene, action with shelter material: protect one willing creature in your zone from one named ordinary rain, dust or temperature exposure until your next turn. No weapons, vacuum, pressure, radiation or toxins. Moving together is allowed; separation ends it.

Adept foundation, rank 6 - Read the Territory: once/scene, after ten minutes observing native life, learn an observable sign that precedes a local predator, storm or migration. The sign remains evidence rather than perfect prediction.

Master foundation, rank 9 - Living Refuge: once/session, spend one watch and 1 Supply preparing an existing safe shelter. Up to six compatible occupants gain safe ordinary rest there for that watch despite one named external weather hazard. It cannot restore breached walls, turn hostile ground peaceful or block pursuit.

Tier	Choose one elective	Effect
Novice	**Calm Approach**	Once/scene, action: a non-sapient animal not currently attacked by the crew will tolerate your stationary presence until your next turn if you provide suitable food or distance. Injury, protecting young or incompatible biology can make this impossible; learn why
Novice	**Graft Patch**	Once/scene, ten minutes with living local material: stabilize one damaged ordinary container or shelter seam until scene end. No repair of Hull, wounds, life support or armor
Novice	**Trail Discipline**	Once/scene, after crossing one zone, spend your action concealing ordinary tracks there. It delays a ground tracker by one action of examination; cameras and witnesses remain
Adept	**Hazard Harvest**	Once/expedition, a successful sample task can preserve one useful local irritant as a single-use field marker. It marks a touched surface visibly for a watch; no free weapon, poison damage or Supply
Adept	**Shared Shelter**	Field Shelter may protect a second willing creature in your zone without extending its listed hazards or duration
Adept	**Territorial Reading**	Once/scene, inspect a fresh nest or feeding site for a minute: learn a non-sapient resident's immediate need and one way to avoid disturbing it. This does not command it
Master	**Rooted Camp**	Once/session after preparing Living Refuge, establish an obvious escape route from the shelter to one adjacent safe zone. Occupants can follow without a routine navigation roll; pursuit and new hazards remain
Master	**Keep the Seed**	Once/session, action +1 Supply with tools: prevent a damaged carried biological sample from dying for one expedition. No revival of a person or recreation of extinct life

Tier	Choose one elective	Effect
Master	**Turn the Herd**	Once/session, ten minutes and a plausible ordinary signal: redirect a non-sapient group away from one traversable zone connection. Requires an alternative route meeting its immediate need; does not drive it into obvious injury or control a unique predator

Veilwright

Novice foundation, rank 2 - Controlled Projection: once/scene, action +1 Strain: project a static human-sized arrangement of light in your or an adjacent visible zone until your next turn. No sound, substance, concealment field or attack. Touch or an active scan reveals projection; it cannot create darkness or hide a real person automatically.

Adept foundation, rank 6 - Patient Image: once/scene extend one Controlled Projection to scene end while an anchored emitter remains in its zone. You cannot maintain another projection; moving or disabling the emitter ends it.

Master foundation, rank 9 - Shared Model: once/session, ten minutes with willing participants and recordings: project an interactive reconstruction of one known room or event as evidence supports it. Distinguish known facts, interpretations and missing information. It grants no otherwise unavailable memories or truth.

Tier	Choose one elective	Effect
Novice	**Stagecraft**	A Controlled Projection can include one repeating ordinary sound from a known recording. No private voice imitation without a recording
Novice	**Optical Check**	Once/scene, action scanning a visible image: learn whether ordinary projected light contributes to it, or whether your tools cannot determine that. No universal detection of sacred or biological concealment
Novice	**Light Script**	Once/scene, action: place a short visible message on a surface in your zone until scene end using your emitter. It can be read and erased by others; no hidden mental command
Adept	**Moving Diagram**	Your projection may show one repeating motion within its original zone, but cannot follow someone into another zone or interact physically
Adept	**Signal Check**	Once/scene, successful examination of an accessible ordinary broadcast identifies its immediate relay in the same site, or explains the shielding that blocks tracing. No interstellar location or decrypted content
Adept	**Separate the Layers**	Once/scene, action with recordings: show willing viewers one visible difference between two known versions of a scene. It does not determine which version is truthful
Master	**Emergency Waymark**	Once/session, reaction when ordinary lighting fails: illuminate your zone and one adjacent traversable connection until your next turn. Costs 1 Strain; does not restore power or prevent the hazard that caused the blackout
Master	**Two Windows**	Once/session, Controlled Projection can display two static images in adjacent visible zones. Pay its normal activation cost once plus 1 additional Strain as one packet; neither image gains substance

Tier	Choose one elective	Effect
Master	**Public Record**	Once/session, ten minutes with a cooperating local broadcaster: distribute an accessible copy of one record to its willing subscribers. Fees/permissions remain; you cannot compel belief or prevent later censorship

Overlap and spotlight

Several characters can preserve a record, move a companion or establish shelter. Compare what each costs, where it works and what other choice it replaces. A Chirurgeon needs an action and kit for a small heal; a Biotic specialist changes recovery; a Votary manages Conviction. None should erase another player's opportunity to act. When two packages create the same named benefit, use one benefit rather than multiplying it.

03 / The rite codex

These rites add choices to each Pantheon's library; they never grant a second Pantheon. At creation keep one of your Pantheon's two core starting rites and optionally replace the other with one novice rite below. At ranks 2 and 4, an optional rite slot may choose a novice rite. At ranks 7 and 8 it may choose a novice, adept or core advanced rite. Epic rites require rank 11; legendary rites rank 17. Required Mantle rites take precedence. Rank 11-20 learning follows the long-campaign schedule. Merely owning this book does not add every rite to a sheet.

Shared casting rules

Unless a rite states otherwise: **one action, 1 Conviction**, own/adjacent visible zone, one target, and one named effect. Novice and adept rites have no activation Strain unless listed. Epic rites also cost **1 Strain**. Legendary rites cost **2 Conviction +1 Strain** and are **once/session per named rite**. They still use one action unless a longer casting is stated. Pay before resolution; combine activation Strain with overreach before checking Fracture. Overreach follows core rules and cannot change a ritual's site, watch or material requirements.

A hostile rite rolls Presence. On 7-9 apply its stated successful effect and gain 1 result Strain; on a miss no effect and gain 1 result Strain. On 12+ choose a normal exceptional benefit where relevant, never an extra entire rite. Willing-target and unattended-object effects need no roll unless an external hazard meaningfully interferes. A sacred name is not permission to command sapient beings, erase memory or assert religious truth.

No effect is ship scale unless explicitly stated. A “safe zone” has a physically usable connection and no known immediate unavoidable hazard. Seeing a destination does not create a route. Protection does not revive a Downed creature, reduce existing wounds or stack temporary Guard above 1. A physical component may be disabled through ordinary action/task procedures; a targetable sacred field has Guard only when explicitly listed.

Order

Judgment Arc

Tier: Novice. **Cost:** standard. Make a hostile Presence rite against one enemy in your or an adjacent visible zone. On success deal damage 2, reduced by armor normally. The visible arc follows a clear line; cover gives the normal situational hindrance and solid barriers block it. It has no stun or free additional target. On an exceptional result choose one ordinary exceptional benefit, not another entire strike.

Crossfire Geometry

Tier: Adept. **Cost:** standard. Target up to two visible enemies in the same own/adjacent zone with a hostile Presence rite. One roll applies to both; success deals damage 1 to each, reduced by armor normally. Cover and shielding apply to each: if their net situation differs, use the less favorable situation for the shared roll. One exceptional benefit applies to one target only. It cannot also suppress or create cover.

Falling Lattice

Tier: Epic. **Cost:** epic; once/scene. Target one visible enemy in your or an adjacent zone with a hostile Presence rite. On success deal damage 3 and prevent its next ordinary zone move until the end of its next turn, unless it spends its action breaking the visible frame. It can still attack or use abilities. No pinning ships, crushing body parts or indefinite stun. The target has one unaffected activation after the frame ends before this rite can restrain it again.

Load-Bearing Word

Tier: Novice. **Cost:** standard. Touch one ordinary human-scale load-bearing brace or door frame in your zone. Until your next turn it supports an additional human-scale load without breaking from that load alone. It can still be cut, unfastened or damaged. It does not repair a hull, stop decompression or make a collapsing building permanently safe. Useful to hold a rescue route while others cross.

Equal Footing

Tier: Novice. **Cost:** standard. One willing creature in your zone ignores an ordinary unstable-footing movement check on its next move before your next turn. Fire, active machinery, gaps without a path and enemy attacks remain. The target does not gain a defense edge or extra movement. The visible geometric footholds fade after that move.

Witnessed Seal

Tier: Novice. **Cost:** standard; ten-minute casting. Mark an ordinary closed container you can touch. Until the next safe rest, you can tell by examining the mark whether that closure was opened after casting. The seal neither locks it nor identifies the opener, prevents tampering or proves that its original contents were authentic. Any observer sees the mark.

Boundary Lattice

Tier: Adept. **Cost:** standard. Mark one traversable connection from your zone to an adjacent visible zone until your next turn. One hostile human-scale creature attempting to cross must first spend its action dismantling the lattice; it may then use its ordinary move. Cast with Presence against one visible intended target; only that target is impeded. It may attack, wait or use another connection. No whole army barrier.

Measured Exchange

Tier: Adept. **Cost:** standard. Exchange the positions of two conscious willing creatures in your own/adjacent visible zones, through an unobstructed traversable connection. Both keep their actions and conditions. Neither can be an anchored object or ship, and occupied unsafe destinations are invalid. This is movement through the route, not teleportation through seals.

Quiet Machine

Tier: Adept. **Cost:** standard; once/scene. Touch one unattended ordinary device in your zone and set it to an existing safe idle mode until your next turn. A guarded or dangerous device requires a normal Insight task rather than this rite's automatic effect; the rite provides the interface, not a free bypass. Sentient bodies, life support and enemy weapons in someone's possession are not unattended devices.

Common Shelter

Tier: Adept. **Cost:** standard. Two conscious willing creatures in your zone each gain 1 temporary Guard until scene end. The normal nonstacking limit applies. The rite creates no cover, armor, air or physical enclosure; either target can leave normally. It cannot be repeatedly cast to accumulate a protection pool.

Oath of Passage

Tier: Epic. **Cost:** epic; ten-minute casting. Up to six willing creatures who remain together may cross one ordinary publicly negotiated checkpoint without accidentally violating its clearly stated ritual or procedural sequence. The Guide supplies the correct sequence. It neither compels admission nor hides contraband, credentials, threats or a revoked agreement. An opposed crossing remains an encounter.

Rebuild the Span

Tier: Epic. **Cost:** epic +1 Supply; one watch. Using existing material at a damaged human-scale bridge, build a temporary traversable connection between two visible zones until expedition end. The span carries at most two human-scale creatures at once. It cannot cross interstellar distances, vacuum without suits, active lava or an absent foundation. Enemies can damage the supports through an announced 4-segment task.

Arrest the Cascade

Tier: Epic. **Cost:** epic; reaction, once/scene. When an ordinary device hazard in your zone would destroy a second connected device, prevent that secondary destruction until the end of your next turn. The first hazard's damage still resolves. Someone must isolate or repair the connection before the delay ends or the secondary consequence happens then. One delayed event, never an indefinitely frozen disaster.

Covenant Engine

Tier: Legendary. **Cost:** legendary +2 Supply; one watch. At a cooperating occupied site with intact physical machinery, establish one existing ordinary utility circuit as stable for one expedition: heat, lighting, water pumping or similar. It ignores intermittent ordinary power fluctuation, not total loss of fuel, sabotage, war or missing hardware. Choose one circuit, identify its caretaker and physical shutdown point. This is an institutional resource, not invulnerable planetary infrastructure.

The Unbroken Threshold

Tier: Legendary. **Cost:** legendary; reaction. When one willing creature in your zone would be forced across a visible human-scale threshold, keep it on your side until your next turn. Damage and other conditions still apply. Both of you must remain conscious and the threshold must remain physically intact; voluntary movement ends the effect. Cannot hold a departing ship or stop planet-scale motion.

Ancients

Thorn Flare

Tier: Novice. **Cost:** standard. A hostile Presence rite against one enemy in your or an adjacent visible zone deals damage 1 on success and tangles one carried ordinary item until its next turn. The target chooses which held item is tangled and may spend an action clearing it; integrated body parts are ineligible. If it carries no ordinary item, deal damage 2 instead with no tangle. It retains movement and other actions; no dismemberment or forced surrender.

Winter Breath

Tier: Adept. **Cost:** standard. A hostile Presence rite affects up to two visible enemies in your zone with a brief cold burst, dealing damage 1 each on success. One shared roll uses the less favorable relevant situation if targets differ. One exceptional benefit applies to one target only. Cold is a description of this damaging effect, not a permanent environmental freeze, automatic machinery shutdown or extra movement penalty.

Waking Tempest

Tier: Epic. **Cost:** epic; once/scene. Target up to two visible human-scale enemies in the same adjacent zone. A hostile Presence success deals damage 2 to each. Choose one of those targets to move into one adjacent safe zone connected to its current zone, or leave it in place. One shared roll uses the less favorable target situation. Anchored/ship-scale targets cannot be moved; no throwing enemies into unavoidable lethal terrain or creating a persistent storm. One exceptional benefit applies to one target only.

Borrowed Scent

Tier: Novice. **Cost:** standard. Touch a fresh physical trace in your zone. Until your next turn identify the direction its source traveled across one adjacent traversable connection, if the trace survives there. A missing trail yields no invented direction. Does not identify the source, track through vacuum or distinguish a deliberate planted trace from genuine travel without ordinary examination.

Patient Root

Tier: Novice. **Cost:** standard. Anchor one willing creature to a suitable surface in your zone. Until your next turn it ignores the first human-scale forced movement, taking damage normally. Voluntary movement breaks the anchor. It cannot act as a vacuum suit, survive a severed surface or resist ship thrust. One rite protects one target, not an entire zone.

Seed of Recall

Tier: Novice. **Cost:** standard; ten-minute casting. Store one brief sensory observation you currently perceive in a physical seed or recording focus. A willing examiner can replay that observation once, then the seed becomes ordinary. Interpretation, identity and truth are not certified; shielding and absent senses still leave gaps. No recording of another person's memories.

Trail of Lanterns

Tier: Adept. **Cost:** standard. Mark a route you actually crossed through at most three connected zones at the current site. Until scene end, willing followers can read its direction through ordinary fog or darkness. It reveals no new hazards and grants no movement, stealth or accuracy bonus. Anyone who notices the markers may follow or erase them.

Skin of Seasons

Tier: Adept. **Cost:** standard. One conscious willing creature in your zone tolerates one ordinary local heat, cold or irritant exposure until your next turn. Name the hazard before casting. No vacuum, extreme pressure, radiation or weapon damage protection. It does not change the creature's biology permanently or make a contaminated sample safe to eat.

Speak to the Pattern

Tier: Adept. **Cost:** standard; ten-minute casting. Observe a local non-sapient group without attacking or trapping it. Learn whether its immediate movement is driven by food, shelter, reproduction or an external disturbance, and one observable sign supporting that reading. It does not answer unrelated questions, identify a distant controller or command the group.

Verdant Snare

Tier: Adept. **Cost:** standard. On a successful hostile Presence roll, available fibers, roots or a carried cord pin one human-scale creature in your/adjacent visible zone until your next turn. It can spend its action escaping automatically. No damage, automatic strangling or ship-scale anchoring. Requires real tethering material in the target's zone; sterile bare space provides none.

Memory of Water

Tier: Epic. **Cost:** epic; ten-minute casting. Examine a reachable body of ordinary flowing water. Learn which of two known upstream physical sources most recently contributed a fresh named sample or contaminant, or learn why the available traces cannot distinguish them. It supplies one research fact rather than a past vision. No blood-memory reading or precise location of a person.

Walk the Migration

Tier: Epic. **Cost:** epic; one watch. Guide up to six willing travelers along a known local migration corridor. They avoid one named ordinary seasonal terrain obstacle by taking a physically available alternate path, adding one watch. Active predators, enemies, fuel and pressure remain. If no corridor or alternative exists, identify what is missing before paying the extra travel time.

Shelter of Returning

Tier: Epic. **Cost:** epic +1 Supply; ten minutes. At an existing intact safe shelter, adapt bedding and ordinary air/water interfaces for up to six willing occupants for one expedition. It permits ordinary rest for their known needs, not vacuum protection, wound healing, free food or creating power. The preparations are visible and can be damaged or occupied by others.

The World Remembers

Tier: Legendary. **Cost:** legendary; one watch. At a large physically preserved site, ask three specific questions about observable past physical changes. For each, the Guide provides surviving evidence and a bounded interpretation, or a concrete reason the evidence is missing. No perfect reconstruction, hidden names, mental states or divine authentication. The rite produces records others can independently examine and dispute.

A Seed Beyond Winter

Tier: Legendary. **Cost:** legendary +2 Supply; one watch. Preserve one living non-sapient organism or ecological sample through an otherwise unsurvivable ordinary transport interval, up to one expedition. Requires a sealed compatible container and ongoing power. It does not revive the dead, suspend a person, duplicate the sample, heal injuries or restore an ecosystem on release. A damaged container ends preservation and creates a rescue problem rather than an instant replacement.

Divinity

Searing Lantern

Tier: Novice. **Cost:** standard. Make a hostile Presence rite against one enemy in your zone. Success deals damage 2, reduced by armor normally. Its light is visible, so this is not a concealed attack or a test of the target's moral worth. It does not heal the caster, harm bystanders or reveal private beliefs. Use the ordinary partial/miss Strain and exceptional rules.

Faultlight

Tier: Adept. **Cost:** standard; once/scene. A hostile Presence rite against one visible enemy in your/adjacent zone deals damage 2 on success and outlines one visible equipment weakness until your next turn. The next ally attacking that enemy may claim an edge based on this weakness, within the normal situation cap; using it ends the outline. No armor bypass, extra action, generic expertise or stacking with another edge.

Radiant Reversal

Tier: Epic. **Cost:** epic; reaction, once/scene. Immediately after you fully avoid a visible enemy's attack with a 10+ defense, project a hostile Presence rite at that enemy if it is in your own or adjacent visible zone. Success deals damage 2, armor normally. This is a supplied reaction, not a free weapon attack; pay costs and resolve Fracture before the rite. It cannot combine with another reaction that round, trigger itself or reflect an attack that already injured you.

Lamp Between Us

Tier: Novice. **Cost:** standard. Illuminate your zone and one adjacent visible route until scene end. Choose a visible ordinary color; creatures can see and target through the light normally. Does not expose invisible beings, eliminate cover, create daylight for biological effects or dazzle enemies. You can end the light freely on your turn.

Name the Burden

Tier: Novice. **Cost:** standard. A conscious willing creature in your zone transfers 1 Strain to you. Resolve your Fracture after the transfer. It cannot target yourself, transfer wounds, cleanse a disease or be used to avoid the target's already triggered Fracture. Its intended use is an earlier decision before another person reaches the threshold.

Open Hand

Tier: Novice. **Cost:** standard. One conscious willing creature in an adjacent visible zone may release an unattended hand-sized object it is carrying into your hand through a clear path. The object crosses the real connection. No theft, forced disarm, hostile delivery or movement through a seal. It is useful when an ordinary handoff would require entering a dangerous zone.

Borrowed Voice

Tier: Adept. **Cost:** standard; once/scene. Until your next turn, a conscious willing creature in your zone can send a brief message through your working voice/emitter to listeners you can ordinarily reach. It uses its own words, not yours; no language comprehension, impersonation of an unwilling person or control over speech. One message, not a remote extra turn.

Step Through Fear

Tier: Adept. **Cost:** standard. One conscious willing creature in your zone can end one ordinary frightened hesitation imposed by a listed enemy special action. It gains no immunity to future effects or actual physical danger. If no such condition exists, it receives a clear account of one available safe retreat route instead, if any is visible. This rite does not dictate the player's emotions.

Mercy's Interruption

Tier: Adept. **Cost:** standard; reaction, once/scene. When a visible enemy deliberately attacks a Downed creature in your zone, give one conscious willing ally in that zone permission to intercept if it spends its own reaction. The intercepting ally rolls normal defense and takes the result. You cannot intercept yourself through this rite or make the same ally react twice.

Door of Welcome

Tier: Adept. **Cost:** standard; ten-minute casting. At a cooperating shelter, establish a visible sign that communicates "ordinary refuge is offered here" to a willing observer, regardless of shared language. It conveys only that simple invitation. Hosts set actual terms; the rite does not compel admission, safety or acceptance and cannot conceal an ambush from investigation.

Shared Horizon

Tier: Epic. **Cost:** epic; ten-minute casting. Up to six willing participants present share one currently perceived sensory view supplied by a willing member for a minute. They cannot take control, extract memories or see through an absent person's eyes. An ongoing channel needs ordinary local communication; blocking the channel or the source's senses ends it. No added actions or remote attacks.

Life at the Edge

Tier: Epic. **Cost:** epic +1 Supply; once/session, action. Touch a stabilized Downed creature with fewer than three wounds and a compatible treatment kit. It becomes conscious at 1 Guard, retaining its wounds and other conditions. It cannot act until its next ordinary activation. No death reversal, removal of the stabilization wound or immediate turn. A creature retired at three wounds is ineligible.

The Offered Weight

Tier: Epic. **Cost:** epic; reaction, once/scene. When a conscious willing ally in your zone would take damage, take up to 2 of that final damage yourself after its reductions, before Guard loss. Your share ignores your armor and reductions but spends any temporary Guard normally. No reduction to total damage, transfer of wounds or interruption of an already completed hit. Resolve resulting Downed states separately.

Communion of Strangers

Tier: Legendary. **Cost:** legendary; one watch. With up to twelve willing participants present and shared ordinary communication media, establish a mutually understandable account of one concrete proposal. Each can state one requirement in their own terms; everyone hears an accurate translation of that requirement. It reveals no withheld secret, compels no vote and gives no roll bonus. Agreements still require negotiation and material concessions.

The Last Open Door

Tier: Legendary. **Cost:** legendary; reaction. When a conscious willing ally in your zone would become Downed from Guard loss, leave it at 1 Guard instead and immediately take one wound yourself. You cannot use this at two or more wounds, and the ally cannot benefit twice in a scene. Exposure is consumed normally; other conditions and remaining attack consequences apply. It prevents one fall rather than reviving someone or undoing a resolved wound.

Ritual play and counterplay

Long castings require their full uninterrupted interval. If interrupted before the final action/interval ends, activation resources remain spent and no effect occurs; ordinary preparation materials are lost only if actually damaged or consumed by the event. Announce interruption risks before beginning. A safe site does not require a roll solely because a rite is legendary.

An opponent can contest an ongoing effect through its stated component, physical route, emitter or duration. A social refusal cannot be dispelled as if it were a magical condition. Religious practice can be powerful without resolving an entire expedition from a berth or removing the need for other professions.

04 / Ranks 11-20 and legendary callings

This optional progression replaces the core statement that automatic ranks stop at 10. It does not alter ranks 1-10. Continue earning milestones by the core method; four earned milestones buy one rank during safe training. Award at most four per completed adventure, not per trivial scene. Rank 11-20 therefore represents at least ten substantial adventures after rank 10, usually more sessions.

Keep the scale human

Attributes remain +3, Conviction 3, Strain threshold 4 and wounds 3. Guard does not rise beyond the rank-10 base maximum of 10 before wounds. No automatic second attack or second reaction. Expertise remains a permission plus at most +1 on a relevant task. A rank-20 explorer still needs a pressure suit, can be pinned, and cannot shoot a cruiser with a sidearm.

Higher rank gives more kinds of actions, longer projects, organizational reach and access to demanding rites. It does not make ordinary people irrelevant. A legendary explorer can found a rescue network; a single dockworker can still close the airlock at the wrong moment. Ship scale changes through vessels and objectives, not by multiplying personal damage.

Advancement schedule

Rank	Gain
11	Learn one epic rite from your Pantheon; choose one **legendary calling** below
12	Choose one additional novice elective from your existing Discipline; establish a named institutional relationship through an adventure
13	Learn a second epic rite; choose one additional relevant expertise through training, still one per roll
14	Choose one additional adept elective from your existing Discipline; gain the calling's rank-14 feature
15	Learn one additional core advanced or expansion adept rite; make a second concrete Legacy asset available at a known location
16	Choose one additional master elective from your existing Discipline; no second Discipline foundation tree
17	Learn one legendary rite from your Pantheon; gain the calling's rank-17 feature
18	Learn a third epic rite; choose a Vocation technique from another Vocation, with a teacher and one downtime interval; talents are not gained
19	Learn a second legendary rite; record one sector-scale commitment and the people who can hold you accountable
20	Gain **A Future Left Open**, below; resolve or substantially change one personal thread with the player

At rank 20 you know twelve rites total: six by rank 8, then six gained at 11, 13, 15, 17, 18 and 19. Rank 12/14/16 electives add choices without taking every branch. Mandatory Mantle rites remain part of the known list. A single retraining interval

can exchange one optional rite for another legal rite of equal or lower tier from the same Pantheon. It cannot remove a Mantle requirement or occur during an expedition emergency.

Legendary callings

Choose one at rank 11. Its features do not require a matching Vocation, religion, species or body. Each calling supplies one rank-11, rank-14 and rank-17 feature. No calling grants political authority without relationships earned in play.

Hearthkeeper

Rank 11 - Receive the Lost: once/session, ten peaceful minutes at an established shelter: up to six conscious willing participants clear 1 Strain. Does not revive, treat wounds or restore Conviction. The group must actually reach a safe refuge.

Rank 14 - Prepared Rooms: after one downtime interval and 2 Supply at a cooperating settlement, establish compatible sleeping/treatment space for six. It provides access to ordinary rest and wound care, not free materials, staff loyalty or immunity to attack. The asset remains until physically lost or withdrawn by its hosts.

Rank 17 - Evacuation Covenant: once/session while you can communicate with your cooperating shelter, reveal one prepared ordinary evacuation vehicle and its actual capacity/location. You must have funded and recorded it earlier; this feature ensures its readiness, not its arrival through a blockade. Paying for it uses normal vehicle costs.

Horizon-Seeker

Rank 11 - Question Beyond the Chart: once/session after examining a new route, ask which one observable condition makes it currently impassable. Receive a concrete fact or discover that your available instruments cannot determine it. No automatic crossing.

Rank 14 - Second Survey: once/session after a failed noncombat exploration task, establish one changed practical approach using available equipment. It permits another attempt with newly announced stakes, not a reroll, refund or guaranteed success.

Rank 17 - Bring Them Home: once/session when you complete a meaningful evacuation or return-route objective, restore 1 Accord. Cannot combine with Legacy's Accord restoration for the same objective; choose one trigger.

Concordant

Rank 11 - Seats at the Table: once/adventure, request a hearing from a named institution with which you have Trust +1 or better. If it can communicate and is not in immediate existential crisis, it offers a reachable representative and one concrete condition for the hearing. No automatic concession or safe passage through unrelated enemies.

Rank 14 - Witnessed Terms: once/session after willing parties sign a specific agreement, ask the Guide for one publicly observable breach warning to watch for. This is practical scrutiny, not magical enforcement or private-intent detection.

Rank 17 - A Cost Shared: once/session when a cooperating institution voluntarily contributes a concrete asset to the crew's mission, reduce that asset's purchase/preparation cost by 1 Supply, minimum 1. Cannot discount Stores, personal abilities, wage labor repeatedly or an asset with no cost. Trust is not consumed or automatically raised.

Relicwright

Rank 11 - Safe Bench: once/session after ten minutes studying a known relic, identify which of two proposed ordinary interactions is less likely to damage it. The Guide explains one observable risk. Neither option must be safe, and the feature cannot reveal unknown theology.

Rank 14 - Shared Calibration: once/session, ten safe minutes: exchange one readied relic with a willing ally without the ordinary separate preparation interval. Both still have at most two readied relics and cannot activate an unstudied object. No exchange during initiative.

Rank 17 - Last Safe Setting: once/session, reaction when an activated readied relic would destroy an ordinary tool in your zone, take 2 Strain and switch the tool off intact. This prevents only that destruction; injuries, spent resources and other consequences remain. Resolve Fracture immediately.

A Future Left Open

At rank 20, name a Legacy that can outlive the crew: a free clinic, an archive, a refuge route, a school, a negotiated commons or a repaired planetary system. The Guide offers a final undertaking with three independent necessary achievements: acquire a concrete asset, resolve a contested relationship and survive a physical expedition. Each must support more than one approach. Completing the undertaking establishes the Legacy as a real institution with named caretakers and an ongoing vulnerability.

Once/session at rank 20, after accepting a significant complication that advances your Creed or protects another person's agency, restore 1 Conviction after the consequence resolves. The Guide and player agree that it matters. No trigger from repeating a harmless vow, manufacturing trivial danger or spending the restored point on the unresolved action that earned it.

Continued play after 20 grants story changes, relic discoveries, relationships and institutional projects rather than more numeric ranks. A player may retire the explorer and create a successor at the table's agreed rank. Transfer relationships through actual introductions, not inheritance of every power.

Building high-rank opposition

An epic encounter needs multiple priorities, not a doubled damage number. Use a core enemy with one or two separately targetable components; telegraph hazards and give each component an independent nonviolent disabling method. A component only activates if the encounter explicitly lists an activation for it; an inert component does not add hidden turns.

For four PCs, begin with one elite and two regular threats, or a two-component boss with at most three enemy activations total. For a duet, use one regular plus an objective; introduce an elite only with clear escape or disabling options. Ranks do not make these packages proven balanced. Adjust through observed objective pressure, not automatic rank-based armor inflation. One extra threat should replace another, not silently accumulate with every complication.

Institutional projects

A Legacy asset offers a specific facility or introduction. It creates no passive Supply and grants no control over residents. Record a caretaker, a need, a vulnerability and one use. Once/adventure the crew may undertake one institutional project through the campaign procedure chapter. More institutions create more obligations and choices, not more free actions.

Example: a rank-14 Hearthkeeper funds treatment rooms at Ashfall Harbor. The clinic can host six patients; the crew still buys supplies and performs care. A storm damages the harbor cable. The Guide offers repairing the cable, negotiating a temporary power share or moving patients by crawler. The rank feature makes their preparation relevant without deciding which response is correct.

05 / Equipment and vessels

These items add approaches rather than a ladder of mandatory numerical upgrades. Use core attack, defense and armor rules. Starting explorers may choose a new damage-2 close or ranged weapon with cost 1 instead of a core basic weapon; other items require a supplier, salvage or an explicit adventure reward. A weapon's exceptional option replaces the usual exceptional benefit. A human-scale device cannot harm a ship unless a scenario identifies a vulnerable external component.

Eight weapon profiles

Weapon	Damage / reach	Supply	Option and tradeoff
Arc lance	2 / close	1	Exceptional hit: instead of +1 damage or another exceptional benefit, disable one visible ordinary handheld powered tool the target carries until its next turn. Cannot disable a body, life support or integrated weapon
Monofilament hook	1 / close	1	A successful restrain action can anchor a human-scale target to existing rough terrain. Normal escape action; no armor bypass, severed limbs or automatic critical damage
Breacher hammer	2 / close	2	Gives a plausible method for breaking an ordinary reinforced human-scale door through a 4-task clock. Each task action makes loud noise; does not add damage against creatures or breach ship hulls safely
Pulse bow	2 / ranged	1	Can be operated without a loud report in ordinary air. Its projectile and impact remain visible/audible; no universal stealth bonus or unlimited ammunition fabrication
Foam caster	0 / own or adjacent visible zone	2	Roll Finesse as a strike; on success coat one human-scale enemy's footing, preventing its next ordinary move until it spends an action clearing foam. No damage or suffocation. The target gets one turn free of this weapon's pin after it ends
Resonance pistol	2 / ranged	1	On an exceptional suppression result, choose to interrupt one visible non-sapient alarm speaker until next turn instead of suppressing an enemy. Does not erase a transmitted alarm
Anchor harpoon	1 / ranged	2	On a hit, choose damage or attach a visible tether to a suitable unattended anchor in the target zone. Moving a creature needs the normal restrain/forced-movement method; no automatic drag. Cable can be cut with an action
Thermal lance	3 / close	3	Bulky, two-handed; cannot move and strike on the same turn. Against an unattended ordinary barrier, provides a cutting method rather than rolling repeated damage. Heat threatens nearby flammables; announce it

Zero damage remains zero. Foam does not become damage 1 through armor-minimum rules. Repeated control cannot permanently remove a target's opportunity to act: a target freed from Foam Caster gains one unaffected activation before that weapon can pin it again. An enemy can still attack or operate a control while pinned in its own zone.

Twelve tools and consumables

Item	Supply	Use and limit
Pressure patch	1/use	Action with access to a punctured compatible excursion suit: stop one ordinary suit leak. Does not restore Guard, replace lost air or seal a ship breach
Anchor web	1	Ten minutes secures one human-scale work position in ordinary zero gravity for two people. Can be cut, unfastened or overloaded by ship thrust
Cold vault	2	Powered portable container preserves one ordinary perishable sample for an expedition. Takes a bulky cargo slot on a small vehicle; not suspended animation for a person
Prism lamp	1	Projects visible route marks across an adjacent zone in ordinary darkness. Enemies can see its beam; no universal illusion detection
Ceramic screen	2	Action to deploy an ordinary cover position for one creature in your zone. Bulky, cannot move while occupied; breaks after a scenario-established heavy impact. Cover ends when firing/moving as normal
Mote observer	2	Fragile camera on a tether reaches one adjacent zone through a real opening. One action to operate; no independent turn, attack or automatic hidden-clue discovery
Static veil	1/use	Action disrupts one ordinary local radio channel in your zone until your next turn. Affects allies too. Wired links, shielding and another channel bypass it; no mind-affecting effect
Culture sleeve	1	Maintains one compatible living non-sapient specimen for a watch if fed/powered. It does not domesticate, identify or render the specimen safe
Evidence press	1	Minute's work makes a durable impression of one reachable ordinary surface or inscription. Captures what exists, including deliberate fakes; no dating or translation
Portable winch	2	Action attaches a compatible tether to move an unattended human-scale load along a traversable connection. Anchoring and a second action are needed for a bulky load; never pulls an unwilling creature without normal contest/control rules
Dry ration reserve	1/use	Replaces one missed ordinary meal/water interval for up to four compatible people in a survival scene. Cannot be resold for more Supply or counted as ship Stores; it is an explicit emergency consumable
Interface bridge	2	Provides a physical adapter between two known ordinary device standards. Requires ten minutes and accessible ports; no password, encryption, sentient-body or unknown alien-network bypass

Twelve field relics

Study a found relic for a downtime interval with suitable tools or a knowledgeable willing teacher. Learn its use, cost and visible counterplay before readying it. At most two readied relics per explorer; changing takes ten safe minutes. Relics below are rewards, not automatically available shop purchases. Their described forms can change without changing rules.

Charter Stone

Once/session, ten minutes +1 Conviction: display the exact text of one agreement physically recorded in the stone. Participants may compare it to a later copy. It does not enforce compliance, authenticate original consent or translate a language nobody present can interpret. Erasing its ordinary physical inscription removes the record.

Thread Compass

Once/scene, action +1 Conviction: point toward one carried physical marker you personally placed earlier this expedition within the same site, up to three traversable connections away. Shielded/removed/destroyed markers yield “signal blocked/absent,” not a new location. No tracking a person who discarded it.

Hearth Coil

Once/session, ten minutes +1 Conviction +1 Supply: provide ordinary heat and light to one existing sealed refuge zone for a watch. Needs fuel/materials and no active breach. Does not create air, repair the refuge or stop a weapon. Anyone may switch off the visible coil with an action in its zone.

Pilgrim's Mirror

Once/scene, action +1 Conviction: a conscious willing creature in your zone observes its own current external appearance from another angle. Useful for checking a suit seal or concealed attached device. No soul reading, remote vision, hidden diagnosis or impersonation. Darkness still needs a light.

Copper Witness

Once/session, reaction +1 Conviction: when an ordinary visible recording device in your zone would lose its current file from a power failure, preserve one accessible file in the Witness. Physical destruction before the transfer completes prevents it. No decryption, deleted-memory recovery or private thought access.

Storm Comb

Once/scene, action +1 Conviction: divert ordinary windblown dust from one willing creature in your zone until your next turn. It can see normally through that dust but remains visible to others. No pressure, toxin, lightning or weapon protection. Leaving your zone ends it.

Margin Bell

Once/scene, action +1 Conviction: set a visible audible alarm on one ordinary traversable threshold in your zone until scene end. It rings on the next human-scale crossing, friendly or hostile, then ends. No silent identification, remote tracking or automatic damage. An observer can remove it with an action.

Patient Needle

Once/session, action +1 Conviction +1 Supply with a compatible treatment kit: stabilize a Downed creature in your zone without the usual stabilization wound. It remains Downed and does not lose existing wounds. Must be used before another stabilization resolves; cannot revive a creature retired at three wounds.

Open Atlas

Once/session, one watch +1 Conviction: combine the crew's genuine charts into a legible local route model. The Guide names one contradiction or gap that matters to the intended destination. It supplies no missing chart, secret route or guaranteed safe travel. Publicly displaying the model exposes the crew's known routes.

Counterweight Ring

Once/scene, reaction +1 Conviction: when a human-scale unattended carried object in your zone would fall into an adjacent visible zone, slow it long enough for a conscious willing creature to catch it using its own reaction. Neither gains movement or protection from a hazard beyond. No catching ships, people or deliberate projectiles.

Lantern Without Flame

Once/session, action +1 Conviction +1 Strain: illuminate one adjacent visible zone for a watch without ordinary heat or fuel. It reveals ordinary visible surfaces only and cannot be moved beyond that zone. Anyone can cover the physical lantern; it does not burn, blind, prove divinity or provide a defense edge.

Last Page

Once/session, ten minutes +1 Conviction: a willing participant records a message of up to a minute. The next willing reader touching the Page hears it in the participant's ordinary medium. The Page then becomes blank. No authenticated identity, compelled truth, preserved soul or automatic translation. It is often important because people choose what to say.

Ground vehicles

Vehicles supply movement permissions and capacity, not free PC activations. One driver uses an action for a demanding maneuver; passengers retain normal turns but cannot operate two stations simultaneously. Ordinary travel needs no roll. A hit aimed at an exposed passenger uses that passenger's defense. A hit aimed at the vehicle uses the driver's Force/Finesse defense and listed damage order. Vehicle armor is 0 unless listed. At Hull 0 it stops safely if plausible; announce loss-of-control hazards early. Passengers become stranded, not automatically dead. Repair costs 1 Supply +one watch for 3 Hull at safety. A vehicle cannot be healed by personal Guard powers.

Vehicle	Hull / seats	Supply	Capabilities and limit
Ridge crawler	6 / four	4	Ordinary rough ground and a bulky cargo space; slow, fits only established wide routes, no sealed vacuum endurance
Tide skiff	4 / four	3	Ordinary surface water, one cargo space; currents/storms remain, cannot submerge or cross vacuum
Dock mule	5 / two	3	Sealed low-speed work vehicle in ordinary vacuum; one watch of independent air/power, needs ship recharge, no combat weapon or atmospheric flight
Glider sled	3 / two	3	Descends along a known atmospheric route from a higher to lower zone; no hovering/ascent, one cargo parcel, weather and landing hazards apply

Three additional ship frames

Use the core sequence: PCs choose station actions, then one enemy ship action. Hull is ship-scale; Guard powers do not repair it. All frames cap Stores at 6, use ordinary Stores per leg, start with one chosen module and allow at most three installed modules unless stated. At campaign creation choose one frame, not a free spare fleet. Replacing a frame requires selling/trading a vessel and a concrete contract; the price is an adventure-scale agreement rather than an infinite cash accounting trick.

Frame	Hull / cargo	Distinct feature	Limitation
Hospice	8 / three	A compatible safe treatment bay accommodates six patients; once/expedition it waives the 1 Supply material cost for one ordinary full-day wound treatment	Still takes the full safe day; no extra recovery, revival or automatic medical staff. One weapon station
Cutter	9 / two	Once/ship scene, a successful boarding task at Engagement 3 may establish a physically secure boarding connection one task segment earlier, minimum one remaining segment	No extra gun damage; collar and suitable target surface required. Cannot carry a bulky ground vehicle
Archive tender	8 / four	Once/expedition, one watch comparing accessible records identifies a contradiction relevant to the current route or artifact study	Archive takes one module slot permanently; no private data acquisition or automatic correct interpretation

The original Courier, Surveyor and Hauler remain useful. Exploration utility and cargo can matter more than a Hull point. Capital ships are locations and strategic problems: give them dockable zones, crews, maintenance needs and vulnerable subsystems. Do not represent an entire cruiser as a personal-scale enemy with enormous Guard.

Crafting and modification

To make ordinary gear, acquire the plans/knowledge, suitable materials and a workshop. Spend its listed Supply cost and one downtime interval; a roll is required only when a meaningful external danger intervenes. Making an item does not duplicate salvage profit or create a permanently superior version. Cosmetic work is free in ordinary downtime when no scarce materials matter.

A custom item needs one declared function, reach, use time, resource cost and failure/interrupt condition. Compare it to the nearest item here. If it improves several functions, choose one and leave the rest as description. Experimental unique relics require research plus an expedition reward, not just a long enough shopping list. A modification that adds another weapon station still follows the ship's module restrictions.

Wonders / Discoveries worth carrying

Lantern Reach should leave the crew with stories and strange tools, not only a paid invoice. Before an expedition, prepare one **wonder** that changes a possible approach: an impossible refuge, a folded bridge, a living map or an object that turns a past promise into something present. Put a visible sign of it in at least two reachable places. Players can investigate, leave it, share it or take responsibility for it.

A field wonder is a relic and counts toward the normal **two readied relics per explorer**. Study its behavior for ten safe minutes before use unless its entry requires longer; identify its actual use and limits before a player commits. This chapter's six named wonders use **one shared activation per physical object per expedition**. Passing the object to another person, changing who readies it or beginning a new scene/session does not refresh it. Record the use on the object card; it renews only when the crew completes/abandons the undertaking and reaches genuine safe resupply/downtime.

These are adventure rewards, not compulsory purchases or universal mass-produced equipment. Activation costs below are explicit; do not additionally charge the ordinary rite cost. They are automatic if their conditions are met, so cannot be Pushed. An interrupted long activation spends its costs under core rules. Strong new permissions are intentional: tell players what the wonder **can** do before discussing unusual edge cases.

Pocket Dawn

A hand-sized lantern opens like a miniature sunrise. **Action +1 Conviction:** anchor a breathable ordinary-pressure refuge around up to four compatible willing occupants in your zone for one watch, including in ordinary vacuum. They may breathe, speak, work and stabilize casualties inside. The refuge has a visible boundary, stays anchored and fits an ordinary room-sized zone; entry/exit is possible. It provides no weapon protection or treatment and cannot hold a moving ship together. The targetable lantern has Guard 3, armor 0. At 0 the refuge ends after one clearly announced round, giving occupants time to act. Ordinary compatible lighting/air are included; extreme planetary pressure, radiation and incompatible biology require their own preparations.

Discovery: its glow outlines breath on the inside of an abandoned exterior window. A stranded maintenance worker knows the unfolding gesture. **Decision it creates:** spend the expedition's refuge here, or preserve it for a deeper crossing? **Connection:** the maker's service mark identifies a reachable refuge network that wants the lantern used, not locked in a collector's cabinet.

Bridgefold

A metal ribbon unfolds into a luminous lattice. **Action +1 Conviction +1 Strain:** create one traversable human-scale bridge across a visible gap between your zone and one adjacent visible zone until scene end. It needs a reachable secure anchor at both ends; the second can be reached by an ordinary tether/tool. Up to two human-scale creatures cross at once using ordinary movement. This is a real new connection, not an extra move or teleport. The bridge has Guard 4, armor 0 if attacked; at 0 it folds away after a visible warning, allowing occupants one reactionless move to a safe end if one is reachable. It does not supply air, conceal travelers or support a vehicle.

Discovery: its folded shape appears in a scratched route sketch and a blocked shaft's maintenance label. **Decision:** open a direct rescue route that enemies can also use, or keep the obstacle intact? **Connection:** returning the ribbon's survey log introduces a cartographer who can chart one further lead.

Tideglass

A shell filled with slowly moving light. **Ten-minute preparation +1 Conviction:** one conscious willing wearer breathes ordinary water and tolerates the local pressure of one established shallow/deep inhabited worksite for a watch. Establish the site's usable depth with the Guide before committing; it cannot descend indefinitely. It also permits clear ordinary conversation with another compatible Tideglass-equipped listener in the same zone. It does not grant swimming speed, armor, poison immunity or survival in vacuum. At expedition use end it becomes an ordinary warm shell until refreshed.

Discovery: a diver's visible breathing trail leads to an intact shelter, and their log describes the shell. **Decision:** who gets to reach the submerged controls while the others hold the route? **Connection:** the diver's cooperative asks for an account of the route, opening a real working relationship rather than an automatic ownership claim.

Promise Engine

A compact mechanical heart repeats a phrase recorded by its maker. **One minute +1 Conviction:** power one intact ordinary human-scale utility in your zone for a watch without its normal local supply: a door motor, water pump, lift controller or treatment lamp. It can run only one named device and must remain physically connected. Its visible hum identifies the circuit; disconnecting it ends the effect. It cannot fire a weapon, recharge another relic, create Stores or move a whole ship. It can make a lift or pump function when every ordinary wire is dead.

Discovery: an unpowered bell still rings a recorded maintenance promise; a nearby service diagram names the matching socket. **Decision:** spend its one run on access, rescue or preserving a sample? **Connection:** the original promise names a person or community whose unfinished work can become a personal thread.

Orchard of Echoes

A small branch grows translucent leaves that catch different angles of light. **Ten minutes +1 Conviction at a reachable site:** preserve one genuine current scene as a room-sized interactive light record that willing viewers can inspect for a watch while the branch stays planted. The Guide distinguishes visible facts, interpretations and missing information. Viewers can walk around recorded visible objects and compare marks; hidden interiors and unperceived details remain missing. The branch can later be uprooted intact, but the projection then ends. It does not determine truth, extract thoughts or replay an unrecorded past.

Discovery: living leaves reproduce the crew's own arrival in miniature, and a local child knows how to plant the cutting. **Decision:** preserve evidence, make a public memorial or leave a comprehensible route model for the next travelers? **Connection:** a willing witness can use the record in a dispute, with their own interpretation and wishes intact.

Homeward Thread

A braided cord hums when its two end-knots approach. **One minute +1 Conviction:** designate one physical knot at a safe refuge you actually reached this expedition. Until expedition end, the readied carrier can sense its direction and whether the next traversable connection along their own previously traveled route still leads toward it, within the same site. When danger changes that route, the cord indicates the blocked connection rather than inventing passage. Its one activation persists; subsequent readings during the expedition are not new activations. It cannot cross sealed walls, locate an unvisited home or teleport. It does make a frightening retreat possible through darkness and misleading signs.

Discovery: an old route marker carries the matching weave; a traveler in the refuge recognizes its song. **Decision:** which refuge becomes the crew's real point of return? **Connection:** leave the anchor knot with a named willing host who expects a future visit, a report or a story rather than automatic tribute.

Place the wonder in play

For the first few adventures offer at most one new field wonder per expedition. Sharing a useful object is a crew decision, not a private competition to loot first. At least one use should be apparent in the current adventure, and at least one should invite a later expedition. Ordinary payment remains: do not replace a promised wage after the fact with an object the crew never agreed to accept.

Adventure	Where to reveal it	Immediate possibility
The Silent Berth	Rask's emergency locker; its label also appears on a hostel checklist	Pocket Dawn provides refuge along the exterior maintenance route or a reserve for later rescue
The Glass Orchard	A visible sealed survey cache near the terrace rim, described by the researchers	Tideglass opens an ordinary submerged survey route after safe preparation
The Broken Beacon	Refuge workers' tool crate, also marked on the lift diagram	Promise Engine can run the intact lift without repairing its feed
The Prism Vault	A clearly cataloged unclaimed travel locker beside the requested case	Bridgefold can cross a damaged service gap or become a later expedition tool
Hunt Beneath the Salt Crown	A survivor's known refuge kit offered in thanks, never looted from a living person	Homeward Thread makes the Cave a navigable return point
The Harbor Inside the World	A living record cutting freely offered by Habitation after consent	Orchard of Echoes gives residents a shared visible account of the repaired worksite

The Guide adds these placements as part of the revised reward guidance. A wonder that supplies an alternate route does not also complete unrelated task clocks. Its connection should open a playable relationship or question. Reward curiosity with a concrete fact before asking for another research roll.

Ready crew / Six Open Horizons explorers

Paper-play starters using the expansion. All are rank 1: Guard 6, Strain 0/4, Conviction 2/3, wounds 0/3, light armor available once/scene. Each has one move/action per turn, one supplied reaction per round, a communicator, compatible sealed excursion suit, food/water and three personal possessions. No Discipline or Mantle yet. Use the core rank-2 and rank-3 choices when advancing. The offline companion does not implement these expansion identities; do not import them as if they were core fixtures.

Use new Vocations, peoples/bodies and the rite codex for full feature limits. These are unplayed starters, not completed playtest records. The crew shares one ship and the ordinary crew resource pools.

Mara Kes

Divinity / Lantern · Human / Symbiotic · Clinic-Fostered · Chirurgeon. Force +0, Finesse +1, Insight +2, Presence +1. Expertise: Care and Machinery; only one applies to a roll. Core affinity Shared Breath; rites Sanctuary and Name the Burden. Starting talent Triage Eye; technique Field Dressing. Symbiotic body identifies/preserves a compatible ordinary irritant sample through its listed action, kit and consent requirements.

Gear: treatment kit, boarding blade (damage 2 close), light armor, rescue sling. **Creed:** "I will ask what care someone wants, even under pressure; I will never turn treatment into a demand for obedience." **Home:** a mixed-faith shipboard clinic. **Contact:** practitioner Iri, who can provide reachable safe treatment space once/adventure; materials/time remain payable. **Thread:** find a missing mentor's unfinished evacuation roster. **Personal items:** chipped cup, repair charm, handwritten consent cards.

First decision: a conscious ally can regain 2 Guard from Field Dressing once/scene; a Downed ally needs ordinary stabilization instead. Neither erases a wound. Mara can ask her human versatility to express another technical training only by changing that chosen expertise between adventures, not claiming every tool skill during play.

Teth Rin

Order / Dissenter · Koruun / Modular · Archive-Raised · Cipher. Force +0, Finesse +1, Insight +2, Presence +1. Expertise: Records. Core affinity Prepared Ground; rites Bastion and Witnessed Seal. Starting talent Audit Trail; technique Cold Copy. Koruun Sure Hold permits ordinary rough-surface climbing without extra actions; Modular fitting currently holds a recording lens, with an ordinary light fitting carried as the second choice.

Gear: terminal, recording kit, compact sidearm (damage 2 ranged), light armor. **Creed:** "I will preserve the inconvenient record, even when my employer is embarrassed; I will never sell another person's private testimony." **Home:** an archive loading district. **Contact:** archivist Per, who can identify one accessible source or its custodian once/adventure. **Thread:** return a record deposited under a misspelled family name. **Personal items:** brass bookmark, small cloth banner, obsolete access card.

First decision: Cold Copy preserves a file Teth can already access; it does not decrypt a protected terminal. Bastion can protect an ally while Teth spends a later action working a real device task. No ability treats a mechanical person as an unattended terminal.

Iona Reed

Ancients / Wanderer · Ilyri / Resonant · Festival-Taught · Cantor. Force +0, Finesse +1, Insight +1, Presence +2. Expertise: Improvisation. Core affinity Wayfinding; rites Living Path and Seed of Recall. Starting talent Common Measure; technique Hold Attention. Pressure Reading detects ordinary airflow after a minute; Resonant transmission costs an action +1 Strain once/scene and needs a compatible reachable receiver.

Gear: signal instrument, communicator, impact staff (damage 2 close), light armor. **Creed:** "I will make room for an unfinished story, even when silence would be easier; I will never make an audience's belief the price of help." **Home:** an itinerant performance convoy. **Contact:** venue worker Osa, who can arrange an ordinary public space once/adventure. **Thread:** discover why an old rescue song names a harbor that official charts omit. **Personal items:** folded stage cloth, travel ribbon, one recorded laugh.

First decision: Common Measure transfers 1 Strain from a willing ally to Iona; it does not delete it. Stop before taking enough to Fracture unless prepared for the consequence. Seed of Recall stores what Iona currently perceives rather than an invented memory.

Aven Holt

Order / Architect · Asteri / Unmodified · Treaty-Ward · Marshal. Force +1, Finesse +1, Insight +0, Presence +2. Expertise: Records. Core affinity Prepared Ground; rites Measure the Fault and Equal Footing. Starting talent Clear Assignment; technique Secure the Position. Patient Witness reads a fixed surface's physical changes after ten minutes; Unmodified's once/session practical reconsideration does not automatically succeed at the next attempt.

Gear: signal kit, communicator, field carbine (damage 2 ranged), light armor. **Creed:** "I will share the plan, even when I fear disagreement; I will never mistake my commission for ownership of another person." **Home:** a treaty habitat. **Contact:** interpreter Sen, who explains a local formal obligation/appeal once/adventure. **Thread:** identify who removed a public refuge from an old charter. **Personal items:** signed meal roster, worn sleeve patch, carved marker.

First decision: Clear Assignment provides an edge to a concrete ally task instead of ordinary Help, not another +1 layered onto it. Secure the Position needs cover large enough to share; its rules cannot create an obstacle where none exists.

Rell-of-the-Quiet

Ancients / Keeper · Tessari / Augmented · Storm-Schooled · Surveyor. Force +0, Finesse +2, Insight +1, Presence +1. Expertise: Routes. Core affinity Wayfinding; rites Star Witness and Patient Root. Starting talent First Reading; technique Find the Interface. Quiet Signal uses six agreed visible signals; Augmented fitting is low-light optics, not a permanent defense bonus or vision through walls.

Gear: survey kit, sample case, pulse bow (damage 2 ranged), light armor. **Creed:** "I will name the uncertainty, even when a sponsor wants certainty; I will never put another crew into a hazard I concealed." **Home:** an orbital weather station. **Contact:** observer Day, who supplies one current monitored forecast once/adventure. **Thread:** compare an impossible storm record to the actual instrument. **Personal items:** weather glass, shared signal card, painted pebble.

First decision: First Reading asks for one visible hazard sign. Find the Interface reveals an accessible input rather than how to control it. The pulse bow's quiet report does not hide its visible impact or guarantee an unseen attack.

Jessa Marr

Divinity / Threshold · Human / Mechanical Continuant · Convoy-Kin · Corsair. Force +2, Finesse +1, Insight +0, Presence +1. Expertise: Spacecraft and Watchfulness. Core affinity Shared Breath; rites Unmask and Open Hand. Starting talent Breach Read; technique Terms Across the Hatch. Mechanical Continuant survives one watch of vacuum without a suit, then needs shelter/power; starting kit still includes a compatible suit. Guard and wounds work normally.

Gear: boarding blade (damage 2 close), light armor, tether and cutting torch. **Creed:** "I will offer a way out, even when an old enemy refuses mine; I will never count a trapped crew as abandoned cargo." **Home:** an interfaith escort convoy. **Contact:** factor Lin, who arranges a reachable berth/cargo introduction once/adventure, with actual passage costs. **Thread:** recover a contract naming Jessa's former crew as salvage. **Personal items:** freight token, engraved repair panel, sibling's letter.

First decision: Breach Read distinguishes visible decompression/alarm hazards before cutting. Terms Across the Hatch can reveal a genuine ceasefire price, but the other side can decline. Jessa can use ordinary Force strikes when talks fail; her body and faith do not compel either approach.

Shared starting crew

Choose four or fewer of these explorers, or mix them with core starters. Begin with a Courier, one installed ordinary module, Supply 4/8, Stores 4/6, Accord 2/3 and Hull 8. Choose a crew name, a person owed a favor and one reason everyone accepted the same first job. At rank 1 use The Silent Berth or another core starter; advance normally to the rank-2 Broken Beacon arc. To begin directly at rank 2, explicitly apply +1 maximum Guard, one legal third rite and a Discipline foundation/elective to every explorer before play. The listed sheets do not silently include those gains.